

SHARED HOUSEHOLD FINANCE TRACKER

tabs

A reusable expense ledger for any household — two people or more — with per-item splitting, a recurring-bills tab, and a fair-settlement calculator. Backed by Google Sheets.

01 Fresh setup — standing up a new household

This is the walkthrough to set up this application in your environment. It will take about ten minutes, and you only have to set up once. You need a Google account to host the Google Sheet.

Step 1 — Make a blank Google sheet

1. Create a new, empty Google Sheet. You don't need to add any tabs or headers — the script builds them.
2. Give it a memorable name, e.g. "<Household> Finance".

Step 2 — Add the script

1. In the sheet, open `Extensions` ▶ `Apps Script`.
2. Delete any starter code, and paste the entire N-person script (the `Code_nperson.gs` file).
3. Save (`Ctrl/Cmd + S`).

Step 3 — Deploy as a web app

1. Click `Deploy` ▶ `New deployment`.
2. Gear icon ▶ `Web app`.
3. Execute as `Me`; Who has access `Anyone`.
4. Click `Deploy`, authorise when asked (approve the “unverified app” screen for your own script), and copy the `/exec` URL.

Step 4 — Connect and configure the household

1. Open the app (`tabs.html`) in a browser.
2. Paste the `/exec` URL, click `Connect`. Because the sheet is empty, the app shows the setup screen.
3. Choose how many people (use `+` / `-`), type each name, and click **Save household**.
4. The roster saves to the sheet and the main app appears. Everyone who shares the sheet now sees the same household.

Step 5 — Share with the household

Host the webpage so everyone can open it — the easiest free route is [Netlify Drop](#) (drag the HTML file on, no account, get a link). Send that link plus the `/exec` URL to each roommate; they open it, paste the URL once, and they're in.

Getting it wrong / starting over

If names were mistyped, use **Reset household** (bottom of the app). It clears the roster so you can re-enter names; existing expenses are left untouched. To wipe everything, just delete the tab contents in the sheet directly.

08 Everyday use

Adding an expense

- Type item, price, pick who paid, optional note.

- Everyone is included in the split by default. **Uncheck** anyone not in on this item — including the payer, if they paid for something they don't use.
- Add. It appears under Open and updates the settlement immediately.

Settling

- Read the settle-up list and make the actual payments (cash, transfer, however you do it).
- Then mark items settled — the ✓ on each, or **Settle all open items** to clear the whole balance at once. Settled items move to the Settled section; the balance returns to zero.

Recurring bills

- Add each standing bill once on the Recurring Finance tab, choosing its fixed participants.
- Each month, mark it paid with ✓. It resets to due automatically next month.

Seeing others' changes

Hit ↻ **Refresh** or reload. There is no live sync — this is the one limitation of a Sheets backend. For a household it's rarely a problem.